

GOD OUR FATHER

INTRO: One of the many important decisions confronting new parents is, “*What will we name our baby?*” (I am a Jr. – We have four children – Jason & Kim – Jeremy & Larissa - We have six grandchildren – Braden, Rylee, Abrianna, Gabriel, Mason & Mila.)

The decision to name a child is one of the most important decisions a parent will make because it is one that will likely follow the child the rest of their lives! Unless the child decides to go through the legal process of changing their name, they are stuck with the name they have been given, for a lifetime. They are saddled with the negative or positive consequences of a decision they had no influence over!

I could spend the rest of this service calling the names of people who have wonderful names, and the very mention of their name brings

positive thoughts. On the other hand, some names leave you wondering, “*What was the parent thinking?*”

Quite honestly, I have met a handful of people along the way, that if my parents had given me such a name, I would have gone to court and changed my name when I was old enough to do so! My thinking on this is, if they were thoughtless enough to do this to a child, they should be numb witted enough not to be offended when their child changes their name!

Because of the importance of a name, most new parents spend hours, days, weeks, even months debating this question. Most parents arrive at a good enough decision.

Susan and I have been through this process two times. Jason means “*Healer*”, Don means “*Ruler.*” The name Larissa means “*Cheerful or lighthearted*” and Suzanne means “*Lily.*”

Names are important because one tends to become what the name represents. Once the parents have decided on a name, the real challenge begins: helping the child live up to the name they have been assigned.

Every so often we run across a person with multiple names, such as Charles Phillip Arthur George Windsor. (I just want to say – Why did you do that to that child?) That sounds odd to us, until we discover it's Prince Charles! Such a name is quite long for a child to bear, but Prince Charles is royalty, and royalty calls for such a name.

We are currently doing a series on The Father – So, over the next two Sunday's I would like to focus on the name “*Everlasting Father*”.

EVERLASTING FATHER

In the Hebrew, the phrase “*Everlasting Father*” literally means “*the Father of Eternity*.”

This is a brain teaser, but God existed before

time began. He has been declared to have an ***“Everlasting priesthood.”*** If one is everlasting, they are without beginning and without ending! He is timeless:

- He is before time...
- He is above time... ***“One day is as a thousand years and a thousand years as one day.”***
- He is beyond time... He is the only one that can stand in the present and speak of the future in past tense!

Oh - by the way - I am speaking of our Father!

In a very literal sense, He is the possessor of eternity! Eternity belongs to our Father! As a result, He gives us eternal life, because it is His to give! (Larissa telling a Board Member *“My Daddy owns this whole place!”*)

He is:

- The alpha and the omega...
- The first and the last...

- The beginning and the end...
- The keeper of creation...
- The creator of all...
- The architect of the universe...
- The manager of everything...

He:

- Always was...
- Always is...
- Always will be...

He is:

- Undeniable...
- Unmistakable...
- Unmoved...
- Unchanged...
- Undefeated...
- ... and never Undone!

END OF SERMON ONE

GOD OUR FATHER

EVERLASTING FATHER

Speaking of eternity draws our minds into a dimension that almost depletes our brain power. Eternity has no beginning and no ending. When I say that we have an Everlasting Father, I am calling you to remember that our Father has a starting point that transcends time, and continues into infinity.

For us, the Eternal part of His existence is absolutely essential because no one lives forever! But our Father does! That is wonderful for us because we run out of time, but He has more time than He has anything else!

Sooner or later, we will find our own place in the cemetery. We are temporal beings rather than immortal beings. The human body has a shelf life! The state of man is one of transition! We are always in a state of transition! We're here today and gone tomorrow! The Word compares the life of a man to:

- The wind...
- A vapor...
- A shadow...
- A flower...
- The grass...

A dead God will do us no good, dying men need an undying God! (*My God is not dead, sorry about yours!*)

In the earthly realm, the promise to be a good father is only good for a few decades at the very best. (Story of giving Larissa away)

Because he is like a father, the message being sent in being an “***Everlasting Father***” is one of security. As our father He cares for his people and they in turn feel secure. Please know He is not a father that will be there until something better comes along, His promise is to be a Father Forever!

Some of you will have a difficult time with this title because you had an earthly father who abandoned you; that person was not a Father Forever or maybe not at all! Others had a wonderful father, but their father died, their father was not a Father Forever!

I am father to Jason and Larissa, but I cannot commit to being there for them forever! All human fathers will sooner or later pass from the stage of action, but the Heavenly Father is a Father Forever! (Mason – *“I stay with you forever”*)

As an earthly father, when my children have a need, I attempted to meet it! They belong to me, and I love them very much. I would do anything within my power for them! I would take a bullet for them!

Someone said, *“A father is a man who has pictures where his money used to be!”*

Charles Wadsworth said, *“By the time a man is old enough to realize his father was right, he*

usually has a son who thinks he is wrong!”

What I am to my children, in an inferior manner, the Father is to all of us, in a completely perfect way. Matthew 7:11 (NKJV)
“If you then, being evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father who is in heaven give good things to those who ask Him!”

One of the greatest opportunities of fatherhood is that of setting an example for our children to follow. Clarence Kelland said, *"My father didn't tell me how to live; he lived; and let me watch him do it."*

Another terrific opportunity of fatherhood is the level of care and concern we can show to our families. The problem for us earthlings is that in some way, we are all flawed. Because He is our perfect Everlasting Father:

- When we fail, He forgives us!
- When we fall, He lifts us up!

- When we are weak, He is strong!
- When we are lost, He is the Way!
- When we are afraid, He is our courage!
- When we stumble, He steadies us!
- When we are broken, He mends us!
- When we are blind, He gives us sight!
- When we are hungry, He feeds us!
- When we face trials, He is with us!
- When we face persecution, He shields us!
- When we face problems, He comforts us!
- When we encounter loss, He provides for us!

Because He is our Everlasting Father we can rest assured:

- He will never leave us...
- He will never forsake us...
- He will never mislead us...
- He will never forget us...
- He will never overlook us...
- He will never mistreat us...
- ...and He will never cancel our appointment

in HIS appointment book! (Larissa calling the office and asking me to come home)

The ultimate goal, of the Everlasting Father is a relationship with us! Someone said, “*A truly rich man is one whose children run into his arms when his hands are empty.*” I would follow this Everlasting Father if He had nothing to give!